

DON'T GET FORKED

PLACEHOLDER — subtitle to be written

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PLACEHOLDER

cover art to be made (612×792)

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VERSION 0.1

GAME DESIGN & WRITING

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EDITING, LAYOUT & ILLUSTRATION

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TYPEFACES

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PLAY IT ONLINE

A companion game system for Foundry Virtual Tabletop:
github.com/PainHog/DontGetForked

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PART ONE

Playing the Game

*The Entities, the dice, the raid, Suspicion, the chase and how
the year went: everything the players need at the table.*

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CHAPTER 1

The Game

YOU PLAY CLASSIC MONSTERS WHO SHARE A CASTLE IN the woods. Once a year, on the town's festival night, when everyone is in costume, you go down to steal what the castle needs. Get the shopping list home before dawn — and if the job goes wrong, outrun the mob before it corners you with pitchforks.

What a Session Is

Each session is one **raid** on a town you have never seen before. It is always the year's first stock-up: nothing from earlier raids carries over unless your group uses the optional campaign rules (Chapter 7). A raid runs **2–3 hours**.

Who Plays

3–5 players each play one of the eight **Entities**. One more person is the **Storyteller**, who runs the town, its villagers and the mob. The tone is horror-comedy for about 12 and up: real stakes, dark jokes, nothing gory.

What You Need

- A set of polyhedral dice for each player: d4, d6, d8, d10 and d12.
- An Entity sheet for each player, and something to track Suspicion, Turns and the Lead.
- A town to raid: a premade one, a map, or one rolled on the random tables (Chapter 8).

THE RAID AT A GLANCE

- **Roll the shopping list:** one or two essentials, the rest extras.
- **Visit the town's locations** before dawn, getting past their obstacles and taking the loot.
- **Choose on every roll:** hide behind your Mask, or let the Monster out.
- **Watch Suspicion:** at the Limit, the whole town hunts you.
- **Get out of town** with the goods — or run for it, and don't get forked.

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CHAPTER 2

The Entities

EIGHT ENTITIES SHARE THE CASTLE: DRACULA, Frankenstein's creature, the Mummy, the Werewolf, the Invisible Man, a Ghost, a Witch, and Jekyll & Hyde. Each player picks one. No two players in a party play the same Entity.

Five Traits

Every Entity has five **traits**:

TRAIT	FOR
Brawn	Force, lifting, breaking, fighting
Nimble	Climbing, running, slipping free
Sly	Sneaking, hiding, stealing
Charm	Talking, bluffing, passing as human
Wits	Noticing, knowing, figuring things out

Each trait is rated as a die. **Every Entity has one each of d12, d10, d8, d6 and d4**, placed differently: what one Entity does with a d12, another fumbles with a d4. Jekyll & Hyde has two forms on one sheet, each with its own arrangement of the same five dice.

The Mask and the Monster

Every roll adds a second die to the trait die. You choose which: the **Mask d6**, passing as human, or the **Monster d10**, letting the monster out. The Monster is stronger, but it risks Suspicion (Chapter 3). Every Entity has the same pair.

What Every Entity Has

- **Its dice arrangement.**
- **A signature ability**, and a second ability chosen as its **Gift**.
- **A Weakness**: something the town can use against it.
- **A Tell**: how it gives itself away.

Three Picks

Each Entity is premade, with three picks. Every pick has a marked default and a random-table entry, so a new player can skip the choices.

- **Gift**: one of three versions of the Entity's second ability.
- **Perk**: one of three passive edges; each bends one rule in one situation, every time.
- **Castle Duty**: one of the castle's household jobs, shared by all the Entities, each with a small edge tied to the shopping list. No two Entities in a party take the same Duty.

Charges

Every Entity has **3 charges**. One charge pays for one use of an ability. Charges refill once a year, at the castle; any you don't spend on a raid are lost, so spend them.

ABILITIES NEVER PASS AUTOMATICALLY

Every ability does one of four things: raise a die one size; use the ability's trait instead of the one called for; roll the Monster die without risking Suspicion; or open an approach nobody else can take. All of them still need a roll (Chapter 3).

The Eight

Dracula

Brawn **d8** · Nimble **d10** · Sly **d6** · Charm **d12** · Wits **d4**

Mesmerise (signature): open an approach with Charm. He bends a mind with a look.

PLACEHOLDER — Gifts, Perks, Weakness, Tell, and the costume and revealed portraits.

Frankenstein's Creature

Brawn **d12** · Nimble **d8** · Sly **d6** · Charm **d4** · Wits **d10**

Brute Force (signature): use Brawn instead of the trait called. Stronger than any man, it breaks what others pick.

PLACEHOLDER — Gifts, Perks, Weakness, Tell, and the costume and revealed portraits.

The Mummy

Brawn **d10** · Nimble **d4** · Sly **d6** · Charm **d8** · Wits **d12**

Ancient Lore (signature): use Wits instead of the trait called. It knew this trick three thousand years ago.

PLACEHOLDER — Gifts, Perks, Weakness, Tell, and the costume and revealed portraits.

The Werewolf

Brawn **d10** · Nimble **d12** · Sly **d6** · Charm **d4** · Wits **d8**

Good Dog (signature): roll the Monster die without risking Suspicion. If the wolf shows, the crowd sees a very large dog.

PLACEHOLDER — Gifts, Perks, Weakness, Tell, and the costume and revealed portraits.

The Invisible Man

Brawn **d4** · Nimble **d8** · Sly **d12** · Charm **d6** · Wits **d10**

Unseen (signature): roll the Monster die without risking Suspicion. When the monster shows, there's nothing to see.

PLACEHOLDER — Gifts, Perks, Weakness, Tell, and the costume and revealed portraits.

A Ghost

Brawn **d4** · Nimble **d12** · Sly **d10** · Charm **d8** · Wits **d6**

Through the Wall (signature): open an approach with Nimble. It drifts in where there's no door.

PLACEHOLDER — Gifts, Perks, Weakness, Tell, and the costume and revealed portraits.

A Witch

Brawn **d6** · Nimble **d4** · Sly **d10** · Charm **d8** · Wits **d12**

Hedge Spell (signature): raise a trait die one size, on any roll in the same place, hers or a friend's.

PLACEHOLDER — Gifts, Perks, Weakness, Tell, and the costume and revealed portraits.

Jekyll & Hyde

Jekyll: Brawn **d4** · Nimble **d6** · Sly **d8** · Charm **d12** · Wits **d10**

Hyde: Brawn **d12** · Nimble **d10** · Sly **d8** · Charm **d4** · Wits **d6**

The Draught (signature): change form, Jekyll to Hyde or back; the new form lasts until the next draught. When the Monster shows on one of Jekyll's rolls, Hyde takes over, free.

PLACEHOLDER — Gifts, Perks, Weakness, Tell, and the costume and revealed portraits.

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CHAPTER 3

Rolling the Dice

WHEN THE OUTCOME IS IN DOUBT, YOU ROLL TWO dice — your trait die and your Mask or Monster die — and add them together.

The Roll

1. **The obstacle sets the trait.** Each obstacle lists one or two traits that work, usually one of them the loud way (Suspicion +1 whatever the result, Chapter 5). Using any other trait needs an ability.
2. **Choose the second die:** the Mask d6 or the Monster d10.
3. **Roll both, add them,** and compare the total with the Difficulty: **6** easy, **8** standard, **10** hard, **12** daunting.

Results

- **Success:** the total meets the Difficulty. You do it.
- **Cost:** 1–2 short. You do it, at a cost the Storyteller picks: Suspicion +1, drop an item, lose a Turn (you skip your next action), or your next roll's trait die one size smaller. A dropped item falls where you are; picking it up costs your next action. The Storyteller never picks a Cost that costs nothing right then (say, a Suspicion +1 the roll already raised); “drop an item” drops one of your own items, never what this roll wins.
- **Trouble:** 3 or more short. It doesn't happen, Suspicion rises by 1, and if anyone is watching, you are caught (Chapter 6).
- **Critical:** a Success where both dice show the same face. In a chase it moves the Lead 2; anywhere else you get back one spent charge, never above your starting number.

The Monster Shows

If you rolled the Monster die and it came up **higher than your trait die**, the monster did the work and it showed: **Suspicion +2**. On a tie, or with the Mask, nothing shows.

Abilities

Using an ability costs one charge. It does one of four things:

- **Raise your trait die one size** (d4 → d6 → d8 → d10 → d12; a d12 can't go higher).
- **Use the ability's trait** instead of the one the obstacle calls for.
- **Roll the Monster die without risking Suspicion:** if it shows, that raises nothing (Trouble or a Cost still counts).
- **Open an approach nobody else can take:** if the obstacle doesn't list the ability's trait, roll that trait at 2 lower Difficulty. Never in a chase. Only you get through, though the way out and a rescue work as usual, and a captive may open its own way out. You are watched as usual.

Spend abilities before you roll. An ability can help any Entity's roll at the same place, even past obstacles you haven't crossed; helping costs the charge, not your action. Several abilities may go on one roll, but it takes **at most one raise**, from any source, Castle Duty included. Raises and steps down cancel out. Nothing makes a die smaller than a d4: further steps down are lost.

Overdraw

At zero charges you can still use an ability, at a price: **Suspicion +2**. Once the hunt is on (Chapter 6), overdraw costs your Weakness instead.

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CHAPTER 4

The Raid

THE RAID HAPPENS ON THE TOWN'S YEARLY FESTIVAL night, when everyone is in costume — which is why real monsters can almost pass in the crowd. Dawn ends it.

PLACEHOLDER — the festival's name and customs.

The Shopping List

Before the raid, the Storyteller rolls the shopping list on a table (premade raids give their own): **3 items on Easy, 4 on Standard and Hard**. One or two are **essentials**; the rest are **extras**. Each item points to a kind of location in town.

The Town

Every town is built from the same parts:

- **An obstacle:** one or two traits that work, and a Difficulty. It is **watched** or not.
- **A location:** 1–3 obstacles, crossed in order, guarding a list item; beat the last and it's in your hand. Its two ways in are two versions of the first obstacle (front door or back window, usually with different traits): the party picks one and keeps to it. It's watched if any obstacle is, either way in.
- **The way out** of town, always watched.

Turns

The night lasts **12 Turns**. The party starts at the edge of town, by the way out, and gets in without a roll. Each Turn, every Entity either makes one roll at its location or moves (any move takes one Turn unless the map says otherwise). Entities act one at a time, in any order, and each result (a move too) counts at once. Several may try the same obstacle in one Turn; each try risks Trouble. The party may split up. **Dawn** comes when the 12th Turn ends: anyone still in town runs for it in the final flight (Chapter 6).

Once anyone beats an obstacle (a Success or a Cost), it stays beaten for the whole party, unless it's marked **group** (a crowd, a guard who checks everyone): then each Entity who wants past rolls for itself. When several roll it in the same Turn (a **group check**), all declare their dice and abilities, then roll together; Suspicion rises only once, by the biggest trigger among their rolls.

Furniture

One piece of furniture or decor (they count the same) stands at one of the list's locations, behind one extra obstacle. Once that location's loot is in hand, the party may take on the extra obstacle and the piece. Bringing it home turns a Win into a **Grand Year** (Chapter 7).

Carrying

- **Bulky** pieces need one carrier, **Huge** pieces two.
- Carriers can't use the Mask die, and roll Nimble one size smaller.
- Huge pieces don't fit through small entrances.
- While carrying furniture, every move takes two Turns.
- Taking a piece is free (no re-crossing); drop it any time. Loot has no limit: hand it to anyone in the same place, free.

Getting Out

The way out is one watched obstacle: **Sly or Nimble, or Brawn the loud way**. The party leaves together: everyone not captured must be there, and one Entity rolls for all. A Success or a Cost gets everyone out, with nothing more to pay. On Trouble, Suspicion rises, the roller is caught (Chapter 6), and the party may try again next Turn.

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CHAPTER 5

Suspicion

THE WHOLE TOWN SHARES ONE **SUSPICION TRACK**, from 0 up to a **Limit**: 12 on Easy, 13 on Standard, 15 on Hard.

What Raises It

TRIGGER	SUSPICION
Trouble	+1
The Monster shows	+2
Taking the loud way	+1
A Cost chosen as Suspicion	+1
Overdraw	+2
A Tell goes off	+1

THE LOUD WAY

When an obstacle lists a loud way and you take it, Suspicion rises by 1, whatever the result.

ONE ROLL, ONE RISE

One roll raises Suspicion only once, by its biggest trigger (overdraw included). Good results never lower it; only a few specific abilities or Perks can, within limits.

Tells

The first time anyone reaches each watched location (the way out and the lock-up included), check once, however the party has split: roll a d6, and on **4–6** a Tell goes off. Roll to see whose, among the Entities arriving: its Tell shows (Chapter 2), and Suspicion rises by 1.

Getting Caught

Trouble at a watched obstacle (it's the obstacle you roll that counts) gets the Entity caught, and a **local chase** starts (Chapter 6). Everyone who gets Trouble in one group check is caught together and flees together. Trouble where nobody is watching still raises Suspicion, but starts no chase.

At the Limit

When Suspicion reaches the Limit — or dawn comes with anyone still in town — the whole town hunts. Every Entity who isn't captured flees together in the **final flight** (Chapter 6). If the Limit comes during a local chase, that chase ends at once (even if the same round cornered you), and those Entities join the flight. From then on Suspicion stops. The track never goes past the Limit; extra points are lost.

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CHAPTER 6

Chases and Getting Forked

THERE ARE TWO KINDS OF CHASE. GET CAUGHT DURING the raid and you run from a crowd; botch the whole job and the entire town turns out with pitchforks.

The Lead

Every chase uses a **Lead** track. Each round you roll against the mob's Difficulty:

- **Success:** Lead +1 (a Critical: +2).
- **Cost:** no change.
- **Trouble:** Lead -1.

Reach the escape number and you are clear. Reach 0 and you are cornered. In a chase the roll moves the Lead: a Cost costs nothing more, and Trouble doesn't start another chase. In a local chase, Trouble and the Monster showing still raise Suspicion (one roll, one rise).

The Ground

Each round, roll a d6 on the chase table at the end of this chapter. The result says which traits work this round for everyone in the chase, and always includes one that isn't Nimble.

Your Weakness

Once the mob brings your Weakness, you roll your trait one size smaller for the rest of the chase. Each Weakness (Chapter 2) says when the mob brings it:

- **Always:** from the first round of any chase.
- **Soon:** from the third round of any chase.
- **Dawn:** only in a final flight that dawn started, from its first round.

The Local Chase

When you are caught during the raid, you run. Your Lead starts at **1** and you escape at **4**. The mob's Difficulty is **10 plus half the Suspicion** (round down), at most 12, checked each round. You may use the Mask. In a local chase, abilities help only your own roll. The chase happens within the Turn it started; escape and you're back where you were caught, with your Turn used up. Entities caught together in one group check flee together on one shared Lead, which moves by the majority rule below, and are captured together if cornered.

Captured

Cornered in a local chase, you are **captured**, and the town takes back what you were carrying: it's gone for the night. You are held at the town's **lock-up**.

- **Rescue:** the lock-up is an obstacle — Sly, or Brawn the loud way, always watched — at the lock-up Difficulty, with a new rescue obstacle for each capture. Getting there costs the party Turns. Beat it (a Success or a Cost) and every captive there is free and acts again next Turn; a rescuer's Trouble gets them caught as usual.
- **Slipping free:** once per Turn, from the Turn after its capture, a captive may try to slip free: Sly or Nimble, or Brawn the loud way, at the lock-up Difficulty. Only a Success frees you; a Cost does nothing, and on Trouble Suspicion rises but no chase starts. A freed Entity acts again next Turn.
- **Left behind:** anyone still held when the party leaves town is left behind (Chapter 7).

The Final Flight

At the Limit, or at dawn, every Entity who isn't captured flees together. The Lead starts at **2** and the party escapes at **6**. The mob's Difficulty is set by the town's difficulty (Chapter 8) and doesn't change with the size of the party. Everyone flees together, so abilities can help anyone's roll.

THE MAJORITY RULE

Everyone rolls each round. If Successes outnumber Trouble, the Lead rises by 1; if Trouble outnumbers Successes, it falls by 1; otherwise it stays. A Critical counts as two Successes.

Escape and you are home with the goods. Get cornered and the party is **forked**: the monsters are killed and the raid is lost.

Once the Hunt Is On

From the moment the final flight begins, Suspicion stops and **the Mask is off**: everyone rolls the Monster die. You may still overdraw, but your Weakness is then in play from your next roll to the end of the flight, and while your Weakness is in play, however it came, you can't overdraw.

The Chase Table

D6	THE GROUND	TRAITS THAT WORK
1	PLACEHOLDER	PLACEHOLDER
2	PLACEHOLDER	PLACEHOLDER
3	PLACEHOLDER	PLACEHOLDER
4	PLACEHOLDER	PLACEHOLDER
5	PLACEHOLDER	PLACEHOLDER
6	PLACEHOLDER	PLACEHOLDER

PLACEHOLDER — the chase table is still to be written; every result must include a trait that isn't Nimble.

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CHAPTER 7

How the Year Went

WHEN THE PARTY IS OUT OF TOWN — OR THE MOB has the last word — look at what came home.

RESULT	WHEN
Grand Year	A Win, plus at least one piece of furniture or decor
Win	Every essential, and at most one extra missing
Partial	Less than a Win, with at least half the list home (missing an essential is at best a Partial)
Bust	Less than half the list home
Forked	Cornered in the final flight: the session ends

Left Behind

Each Entity left behind in the lock-up drops the result one step: a Grand Year becomes a Win, a Win a Partial, a Partial a Bust. Bust is as low as it goes, short of being forked.

The Epilogue

The result decides the epilogue — how the castle's year goes — and nothing else. Nothing carries over to the next raid.

PLACEHOLDER — the “how the year went” epilogue table is still to be written.

OPTIONAL: CAMPAIGN PLAY

For groups who play several raids: furniture brought home becomes a **castle upgrade** with a small, capped bonus in later raids. Nothing negative carries over, and the Entities themselves don't change.

PLACEHOLDER — the castle upgrades are still to be written.

PART TWO

Running the Game

*For the Storyteller: building a town, setting its difficulty,
and running the villagers and the mob.*

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CHAPTER 8

Building a Town

EVERY RAID IS ON A NEW TOWN. THERE ARE THREE ways to build one, all from the same parts — obstacles, locations, and the way out.

Three Ways

- **A premade raid:** a fixed sequence of locations and obstacles, ready to run.
- **A map:** a set of locations the party picks its route through.
- **The random tables:** roll the locations, obstacles, loot and villagers. A difficulty budget keeps a rolled town playing at the difficulty it promises.

PLACEHOLDER — the premade raids, maps and random tables are still to be written.

Difficulty

Choose Easy, Standard or Hard. The difficulty sets these numbers:

	EASY	STANDARD	HARD
Shopping list (essentials)	3 (1)	4 (1–2)	4 (2)
Obstacle Difficulties: share of 6 · 8 · 10 · 12	15 · 50 · 30 · 5%	15 · 50 · 30 · 5%	0 · 40 · 45 · 15%
Suspicion Limit	12	13	15
The way out: Difficulty	6	8	8
The final flight: mob Difficulty	10	11	11
The lock-up: Difficulty	10	10	12

On every difficulty: 3 charges per Entity, 12 Turns, overdraw +2 Suspicion; a local chase starts at Lead 1 and escapes at 4 against a mob of 10 plus half the Suspicion (at most 12); the final flight starts at Lead 2 and escapes at 6.

Running the Villagers and the Mob

PLACEHOLDER — advice for the Storyteller on villagers, witnesses, choosing Costs, the mob and the lock-up is still to be written.

OBSTACLES

Give each obstacle one or two traits that work. When there are two, usually one is the loud way. Mark which obstacles are watched — Trouble there gets an Entity caught — and which are group obstacles that each Entity must roll for itself. Give each location two versions of its first obstacle, with different traits: its two ways in.

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